

Dashboard & Written Report

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1. Introduction

1.1 Organisational Context

Aston Martin Lagonda is a British luxury sports car manufacturer founded in 1913, renowned for motorsport heritage James Bond. Despite its prestigious brand positioning, the company faces strategic and financial challenges. Aston Martin reported a net loss of £323.5 million in 2024, worse than the prior year's loss of £226.8 million (Aston Martin, 2025). The company's entry into the electric vehicle market has been repeatedly delayed, with its first fully electric production vehicle now planned for "the latter part of this decade" (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 12), placing it almost a decade behind competitors such as Porsche (Porsche Newsroom, 2019).

1.2 Industry Context and Strategic Challenges

The global automotive industry is undergoing unprecedented transformation. Stringent emission regulations, notably the European Union's mandate for zero-emission vehicles by 2035 (European Union, 2023), are fundamentally reshaping product development strategies. Consumer preferences are shifting rapidly toward electric vehicles, with 14 million EVs sold globally in 2023, representing 18% of all cars sold and reflecting 35% year-on-year growth (IEA, 2024). Legacy manufacturers face intensified competition from both established brands pivoting to electrification and new EV-focused entrants such as Tesla and emerging Chinese manufacturers.

1.3 Problem Statement

Aston Martin's delayed entry into the electric vehicle market, coupled with ongoing financial constraints, threatens its competitive positioning and long-term viability in the luxury automotive segment. The EU's 2035 mandate will effectively eliminate the market for new internal combustion engine vehicles in a key market. This situation impacts shareholders facing prolonged unprofitability, employees whose job security depends on successful adaptation, and customers who may question the brand's future relevance.

1.4 Report Objectives

This report aims to:

1. Analyse the strategic and operational challenges facing Aston Martin.
2. Apply Soft Systems Methodology to understand the problem systemically.
3. Design and prototype a Business Intelligence dashboard to support decision-making.
4. Recommend data-driven actions to enhance organisational performance.

2. Problem Analysis and Identification

2.1 Strategic Challenge Areas

Aston Martin's vision is to become "the world's most desirable, ultra-luxury British Brand" (Aston Martin, 2024) while integrating sustainability through electrified vehicles (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 6). However, significant challenges hinder this vision.

2.1.1 Delayed EV Transition

Aston Martin's electrification timeline has experienced multiple postponements, revealing strategic uncertainty. Originally targeted for 2024, the Valhalla PHEV experienced multiple postponements before reaching its first customer in December 2025 (Aston Martin, 2025). However, the first battery electric vehicle target shifted from 2025 to 'the latter part of this decade' under new CEO Adrian Hallmark (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 12). These delays incurred significant research costs, forfeited technological maturity, and damaged stakeholder confidence. While the Valhalla delivery represents partial progress, the company remains years behind competitors in full battery-electric vehicles, with Porsche's Taycan launching in 2019.

2.1.2 Financial Performance Challenges

Beyond headline losses, Aston Martin's underlying financial trends are negative. The company's adjusted EBITDA fell 11% to £271 million, with profit margins shrinking from 18.7% to 17.1%. Interest costs are burdensome, with net finance expenses of £189.6 million consuming 12% of total revenue (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 30). This reflects £1,378.9 million borrowing costs carrying interest rates of over 10% (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 187) indicating lenders high-risk assessment. This increases vulnerability to macroeconomic pressure such as interest fluctuations. More critically, high debt servicing costs limit ability to fund electrified programs at the once-promised pace.

2.1.3 Manufacturing and Operational Inefficiencies

Aston Martin's production scale poses a fundamental disadvantage, with 6,030 units sold in 2024, down 9% from 6,620 in 2023 (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 28). Competitors Ferrari and Porsche sold 13,752 and 310,718 units respectively (Ferrari NV, 2025, p. 47; Porsche SE, 2025, p. 125). Despite £245,000 average selling prices (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 29), low volume prevents economies of scale, resulting in decreased margins limiting profitability.

2.1.4 Market Positioning Risks

Aston Martin faces significant market positioning challenges. Geographic concentration creates vulnerability, with Americas and EMEA representing 62% of volumes (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 28), exposing the brand to currency fluctuations. China sales declined 49% in 2024 (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 28), raising concerns about brand relevance with younger, environmentally-conscious affluent customers who prioritise environmental impact alongside luxury. The prolonged EV absence risks positioning the brand as technologically obsolete, potentially alienating customers who view electrification as essential. Despite sales declining 9% to 6,030 units (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 28), Aston Martin's 2024 transformation saw three new model launches without electric capabilities. While Valhalla PHEV was delivered in December 2025, this single model does not fully address the perception gap with sustainability-minded customers in a market where electrification is becoming luxury prerequisite.

2.2 Opportunities

Despite these challenges, Aston Martin possesses opportunities. The ultra-high-net-worth individual population is projected to grow 28% between 2023 and 2028 (Knight Frank, 2024, p. 4), expanding Aston Martin's addressable market. Special limited-edition models priced above £1 million represent only 3.6% of wholesale volume but contribute disproportionately as "high margin" products (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 28, 30). Formula 1 involvement provides potential technology transfer for high performance electric vehicles (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 7). Strategic partnerships with Mercedes-Benz AG and Lucid Group Inc provide access to powertrain and

battery technologies, enabling heritage leverage while transitioning to electrification (Aston Martin, 2025, p. 176).

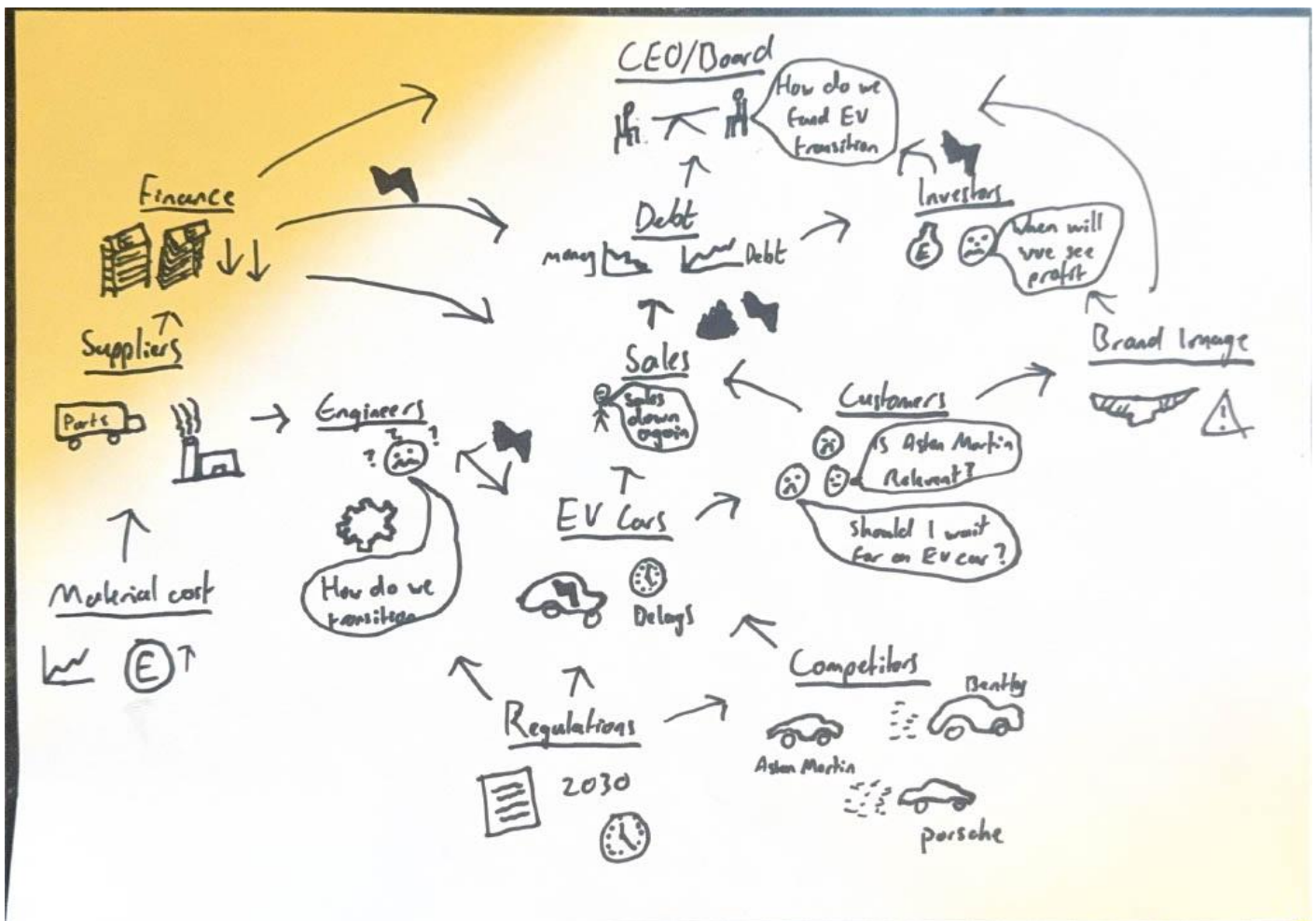
3. Methodological Approach

3.1 Soft Systems Methodology

SSM provides a structured approach to understanding complex problem situations by treating them as human activity systems.

3.1.1 Stage 1: Problem Situation Unstructured

Rich Picture



3.1.2 Stage 2: Problem Situation Expressed

Stakeholder Analysis:

Stakeholder Group	Interests	Power	Influence
Shareholders	ROI, share price recovery	High	High
Executive Management	Strategic success, reputation	High	High
Employees	Job security, skills development	Medium	Medium
Customers	Performance, prestige, innovation	Medium	High
Regulators	Emissions compliance	High	High
Suppliers	Contract stability	Low	Medium

CATWOE Analysis:

Element	Description
Customers	Primary: Shareholders, employees, luxury buyers Secondary: Strategic partners, UK automotive sector
Actors	Internal: CEO, Executive Leadership, R&D/Engineering, Manufacturing, Finance, Sales & Marketing External: Mercedes-Benz, Lucid, suppliers, financial institutions, regulators
Transformation	Transform ICE-dominated portfolio with £323.5M losses into competitive electric luxury brand with positive cash flow and regulatory compliance by 2035.
Weltanschauung	Belief that EV transition is essential for survival, competitiveness, and regulatory compliance, requiring efficiency and financial discipline.
Owner	Board of directors, CEO, Major Shareholders.
Environment	Limited financial resources, Strict emissions regulations, Competitor EV advantage, ICE facilities

3.1.3 Stage 3: Root Definitions of Relevant Systems

Root Definitions:

1. A system to introduce electric vehicles by 2030 through partnerships and technology transfer to achieve regulatory compliance and maintain brand relevance.

	Question	Measures
Efficacy	Is the system working?	• EV vehicles (PHEV and BEV) developed and released • EV development milestones met on target
Efficiency	How many resources are required for it to work?	• R&D per model • Time-to-Market • Manufacturing asset utilisation • Internal vs partner tech ratio
Effectiveness	How well is the system working?	• Long-term strategy alignment • Brand perception on electrification • EV platform readiness • EU 2035 compliance progress

2. A system to restore financial viability through debt restructuring, cost optimisation, and revenue maximisation through improved efficiency and capital allocation.

	Question	Measures
Efficacy	Is the system working?	• Debt restructuring execution • Operating cost reduction • Gross margin per vehicle growth • Positive cash flow
Efficiency	How many resources are required for it to work?	• Overheads vs revenue • Operational cost per unit • Production line efficiency
Effectiveness	How well is the system working?	• Special model profit contributions • Core model contribution margins • EBITDA margin improvement • Self-funding EV programs

3. A system to maintain competitive positioning through brand repositioning, market expansion, and customer engagement, leveraging heritage and innovation to preserve market share and pricing power.

	Question	Measures
Efficacy	Is the system working?	• Customer interest growth • Brand sentiment tracking • Targeted model sales
Efficiency	How many resources are required for it to work?	• Marketing campaign ROI • Sales channel efficiency • Customer acquisition cost
Effectiveness	How well is the system working?	• Market share retention/growth • Pricing power • Repeat purchase rate • Innovation perception vs competitors • China market penetration

3.1.4 Stage 4: Conceptual Activity Diagram

Root definition 1:

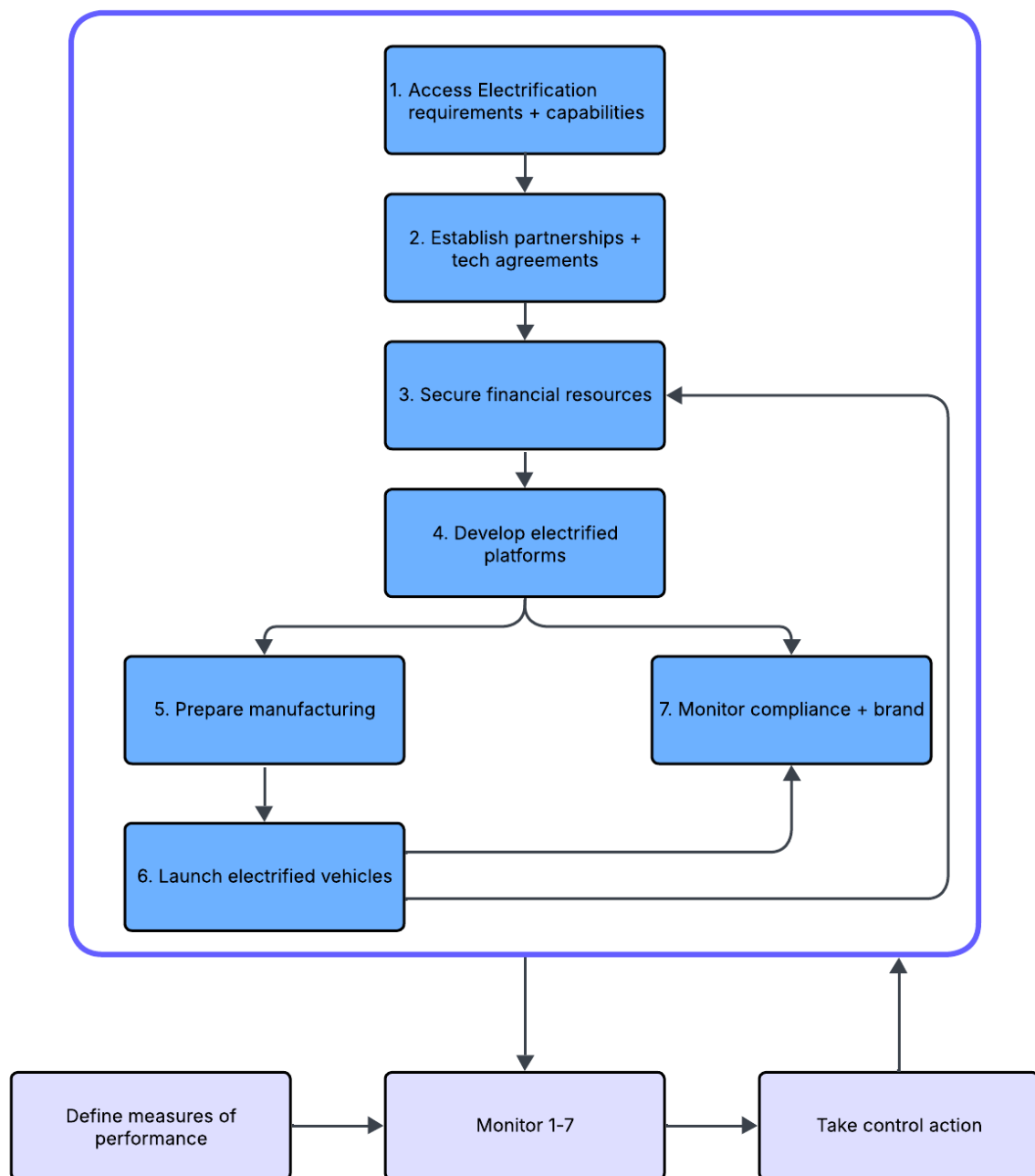


Figure 1: Conceptual Activity Model for EV Introduction System (Root Definition 1). The model shows seven operational activities and monitoring/control subsystem. Arrows indicate logical dependencies and information flow.

Root Definition 2:

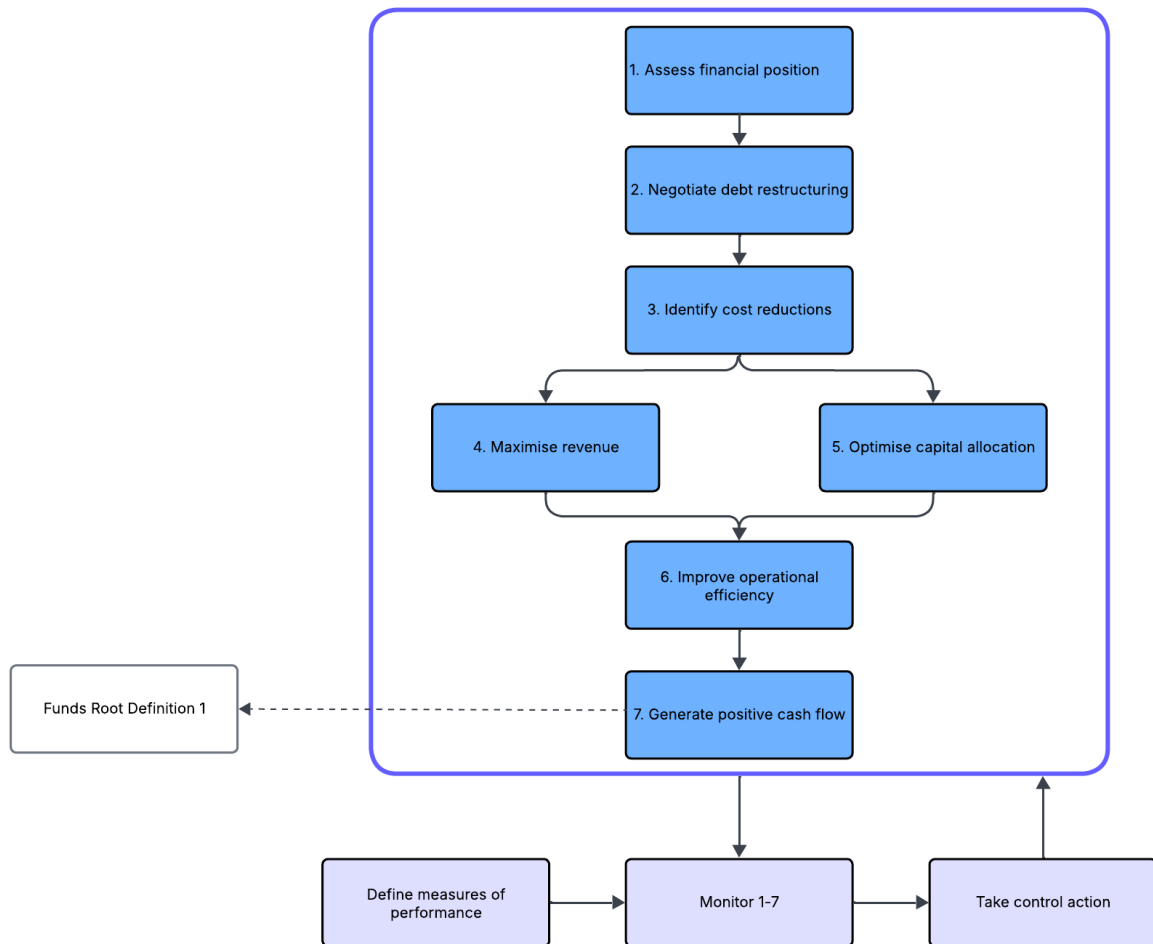


Figure 2: Conceptual Activity Model for Financial Viability System (Root Definition 2). The model shows seven activities for financial viability. Activities 1-3 form foundation, splitting into parallel workstreams (4-5) before converging (Activity 6) to generate positive cash flow (Activity 7), enabling EV transformation funding.

Root definition 3:

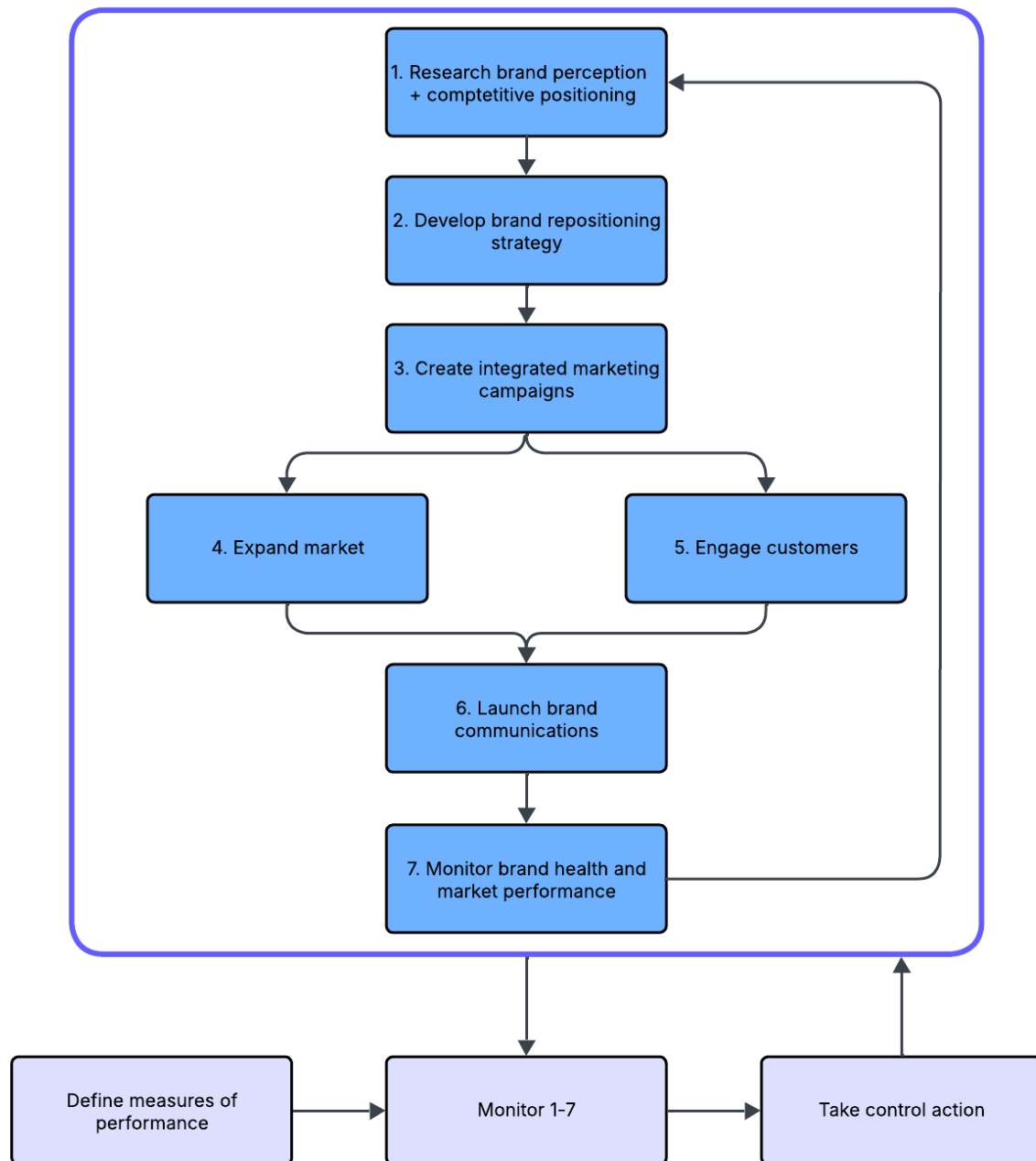


Figure 3: Conceptual Activity Model for Market Positioning System (Root Definition 3). Seven activities maintain competitive positioning, progressing from research through campaigns, splitting into market expansion and customer engagement before converging at communications launch. Activity 7 feeds back to Activity 1.

3.1.5 Stage 5: Comparison with Reality

Root Definition 1: EV Introduction System

Activity	Conceptual Model	Current Reality at Aston Martin	Gap Assessment
1. Assess electrification requirements and capabilities	Clear understanding of technology gaps, regulatory requirements, and capability needs	Timeline delayed to "late decade". Requirements unclear.	Insufficient assessment leading to unrealistic planning
2. Establish strategic partnerships and technology agreements	Active partnerships delivering technology on schedule with clear deliverables	Partnerships formalised but limited outputs after 2+ years.	Partnerships not being effectively leveraged
3. Secure financial resources for electrification program	Sufficient capital allocated to EV development; manageable debt structure	EBITDA fell 11% to £271M; margins declined to 17.1%	Financial constraints blocking all transformation activities
4. Develop electrified vehicle platforms and products	PHEV and BEV platforms in active development with clear milestones	Valhalla PHEV delivered Dec 2025 after delays. No BEV. 2024 launches ICE-only.	Development stalled despite partnerships
5. Prepare manufacturing capabilities for electrified production	Facilities retooled, workforce trained, EV supply chain established	No evidence of EV facility preparation or workforce upskilling.	Manufacturing infrastructure not ready
6. Launch electrified vehicles to market	Electrified vehicles reaching customers by planned dates	Valhalla delivered Dec 2025 after delays. BEV "late decade".	Partial delivery after years of delays. No BEV progress
7. Monitor regulatory compliance and brand positioning	Systematic tracking of emissions progress and brand perception	No visible KPI framework for EV transition in public reporting.	No systematic performance measurement

Summary: Root Definition 1 demonstrates failure with partial success in Activity 6 after delays. Activity 3 is the bottleneck preventing Activities 4-6 execution. Without addressing financial constraints, EV introduction cannot proceed.

Root Definition 2: Financial Viability System

Activity	Conceptual Model	Current Reality at Aston Martin	Gap Assessment
1. Assess current financial	Comprehensive understanding of debt structure, cost	Awareness of £1.38bn debt exists. Response inadequate.	Assessment incomplete or not driving decisive action

position and debt obligations	drivers, and cash flow dynamics		
2. Negotiate debt restructuring agreements	Reduced interest rates (target 6-8% from 10%+); extended maturity dates	Debt at 10%+ interest. No restructuring progress.	Debt burden unchanged, unsustainable
3. Identify and implement cost reduction opportunities	Systematic cost reduction delivering £100M+ savings	EBITDA fell 11% to £271M. Margins declined to 17.1%.	Cost reductions insufficient to compensate revenue decline
4. Maximise revenue from high-margin products	Focus on special editions and optimal product mix	Special editions 3.6% volume. £245k average price maintained.	Premium positioning maintained but undermined by volume decline (-9%)
5. Optimise capital allocation strategy	Clear prioritisation between ICE, EV and debt repayment	2024 Launched three ICE models simultaneously, overwhelming resources	Poor capital discipline. Attempting too much with limited resources
6. Improve operational efficiency	Reduced unit costs through process improvements and manufacturing optimisation	Low volume prevents economies of scale. High costs persist.	Efficiency gains limited by fundamental volume constraint
7. Generate positive cash flow	Positive operating cash flow enabling transformation investment without additional debt	£323.5M net losses. Negative cash flow. Cannot self-fund transformation	System completely failing its primary objective

Summary: Root Definition 2 failing across most dimensions. Activities 2 and 7 are critical failures creating fundamental constraints on Root Definition 1 by preventing EV investment funding.

Root Definition 3: Market Positioning System

Activity	Conceptual Model	Current Reality at Aston Martin	Gap Assessment
1. Research brand perception and competitive position	Regular brand health tracking in key markets with actionable insights	Limited brand tracking. CEO acknowledged 'lost momentum'.	Little research occurring. Reactive monitoring
2. Develop brand repositioning strategy	Clear "heritage + innovation" positioning with executable roadmap	Strategy unclear. Messaging inconsistent. Limited credible EV products to substantiate innovation claims	Cannot fully reposition as innovative with only one PHEV.

3. Create integrated marketing campaigns	Campaigns showcasing technological advancement, sustainability, and performance	Campaign activity limited by lack of EV products.	Cannot credibly claim innovation due to current lack of EV development.
4. Expand presence in strategic markets	China market recovery plan. strengthened Americas/EMEA presence	China sales declined 49% year-on-year. Overall sales declined 9%. No visible recovery strategy	Market position deteriorating rapidly in key strategic regions.
5. Engage target customer segments	UHNW targeting (28% growth opportunity), EV education	Luxury positioning maintained but engagement declining. Limited EV products (only Valhalla PHEV as of Dec 2025)	Engagement efforts undermined by limited EV portfolio.
6. Launch brand communications and initiatives	Active brand presence, product announcements, media engagement	Communications present on cars including recently launched Valhalla.	Communications present, but somewhat constrained by lack of transformation progress.
7. Monitor brand health and market performance	Comprehensive brand perception tracking, market share monitoring, sentiment analysis	Some monitoring evident but incomplete metrics framework	Monitoring present but insufficient for adaptive management.

Summary: Root Definition 3 fundamentally constrained by Root Definition 1's failure. Cannot fully reposition as innovative with limited EV products (only Valhalla PHEV). The 49% China and 9% overall volume decline indicate deteriorating brand perception. Activity 7 feedback loop exists but cannot drive adaptation without RD1 product delivery.

3.1.6 Stage 6: Feasible and Desirable Changes

Stage 6 identifies systemically desirable and culturally feasible changes based on Stage 5 gaps:

Recommended Changes:

Change 1: EV Transformation Governance

Establish a transformation office with CEO authority over resource allocation, addressing RD1 coordination failures.

- *Desirable*: Addresses Activity 1-7 coordination gaps across all root definitions.
- *Feasible*: CEO Hallmark's 2024 appointment creates change opportunity.

Change 2: Performance Monitoring Dashboard

Deploy BI dashboard integrating KPIs across RD1 (transformation), RD2 (financial), RD3 (market) incorporating 3Es measures.

- *Desirable:* Addresses monitoring gaps (RD1, RD2, RD3 Activity 7 failures).
- *Feasible:* Automotive sector standard practice.

Change 3: Accelerate Partnership Technology Integration

Establish joint teams with Mercedes-Benz and Lucid with clear deliverables, addressing RD1 Activity 2 underutilisation.

- *Desirable:* Partnerships exist 2+ years with limited outputs. Acceleration critical.
- *Feasible:* F1 involvement demonstrates external collaboration capability.

Change 4: Debt Restructuring Initiative

Negotiate interest reduction from 10%+ to 6-8%, freeing £60M+ annually for RD1 Activity 3.

- *Desirable:* £189.6M interest is huge constraint blocking transformation investment.
- *Feasible:* Creditors prefer restructuring to default. Requires credible transformation plan.

Change 5: Transparent Milestone Communication

Publish realistic EV timeline with quarterly updates, addressing credibility gaps.

- *Desirable:* Repeated delays damage stakeholder confidence.
- *Feasible:* New CEO provides credibility reset. Transparency uncomfortable but required.

3.1.7. Stage 7: Actions to Improve

Stage 7 translates recommended changes into actionable implementation plan.

Implementation Phasing:

Phase 1 (Q1 2026): Foundation

- Establish transformation governance structure (Change 1).
- Deploy performance dashboard prototype (Change 2).
- Publish revised EV roadmap (Change 5).

Phase 2 (Q2 2026): Enablement

- Negotiate debt restructuring (Change 4).
- Accelerate partnership integration with joint development teams (Change 3).

Phase 3 (Q3 2026+): Execution

- Valhalla PHEV deliveries commenced December 2025, analyse market feedback for brand positioning.
- BEV development accelerates with freed capital.
- Dashboard monitoring drives adaptive management.

3.2 Business Performance Management Frameworks

3.2.1 Causal Diagram

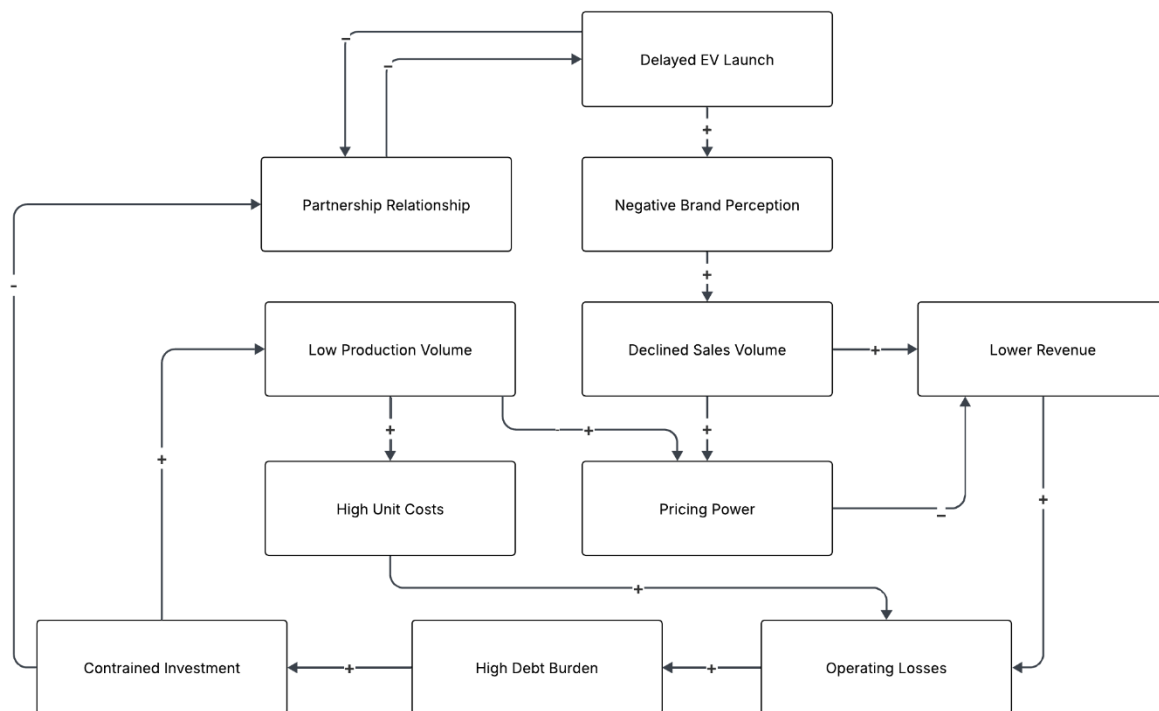


Figure 4: Reinforcing loops creating accelerating decline. Debt servicing represents a critical constraint requiring intervention.

3.2.2 The Balanced Scorecard

The Balanced Scorecard provides multi-dimensional performance views beyond financial metrics:

Financial:

Objective	Measure	Target	Initiative
Restore financial viability	Interest percentage of total revenue	Debt 6%-8% by 2027	Debt restructuring
Improve profitability	EBITDA margin	17.1% to 22%	Cost optimisation
Generate positive cash flow	Net profit/loss	Positive by 2027	Capital discipline
Strengthen revenue	Gross margin per vehicle	+10% per vehicle	Optimise pricing mix
EV Investment	Available capital for R&D	£60-80 Million freed annually	Debt reduction and transformation governance

Customer:

Objective	Measure	Target	Initiative
Increase brand perception	Brand Health Score	>80 by 2027	Brand repositioning and transparent communication (Change 5)
Launch electrified vehicles to market	Number of electrified vehicles launched (PHEV & BEV)	Expand PHEV portfolio 2026-2027. BEV by 2028	Partnership acceleration (Change 3)
Introduce EV's to portfolio	EV sales as % of total sales	15% by 2028	EV platform development
Achieve regulatory compliance	Emissions compliance trajectory	On track for EU 2035, 42% decrease in emissions from 2022	Electrified roadmap execution
Stabilise and grow sales volume	Total wholesale units sold	>=6,500 units in 2027	EV launches and repositioning

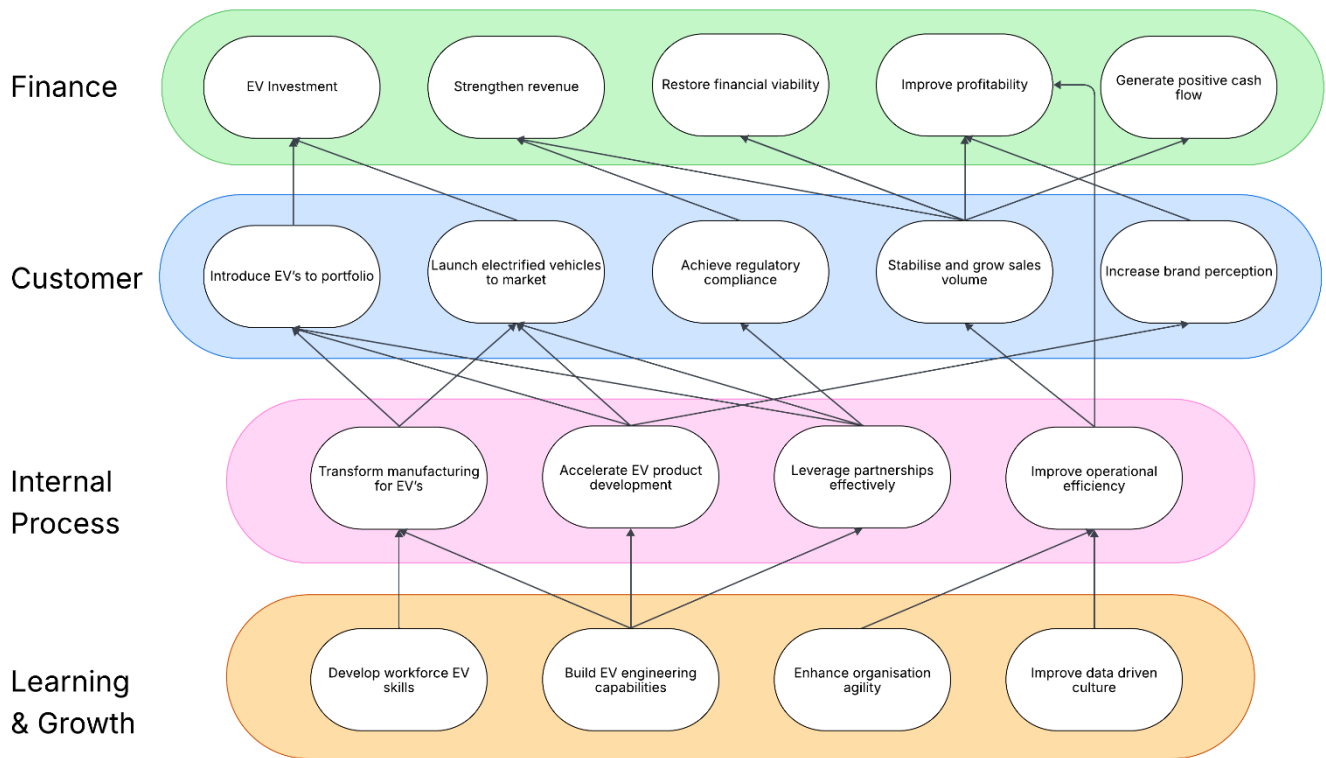
Internal Processes:

Objective	Measure	Target	Initiative
Improve operational efficiency	Unit production cost reduction	Down 15% by 2027	Process optimisation
Accelerate EV product development	EV development milestones achieved on time	100% on time by 2027	Joint development teams
Transform manufacturing for EV's	EV production capability readiness	100% Ready for PHEV by Q2 2027	Modernisation of manufacturing
Leverage partnerships effectively	Partner vs internal technology ratio	70% partner technology and 30% internal	Partnership governance

Learning & Growth:

Objective	Measure	Target	Initiative
Build EV engineering capabilities	EV specialist engineers hired	+30 Engineers by 2027	Knowledge transfer and recruitment
Develop workforce EV skills	Employees EV certified	100% of production staff by 2028	Training and upskilling
Enhance organisation agility	Decision-Making cycles (days)	<14 days for key decisions	Transform governance (Change 1)
Improve data driven culture	Dashboard utilisation rate	>90% executive usage	Performance monitoring (Change 2)

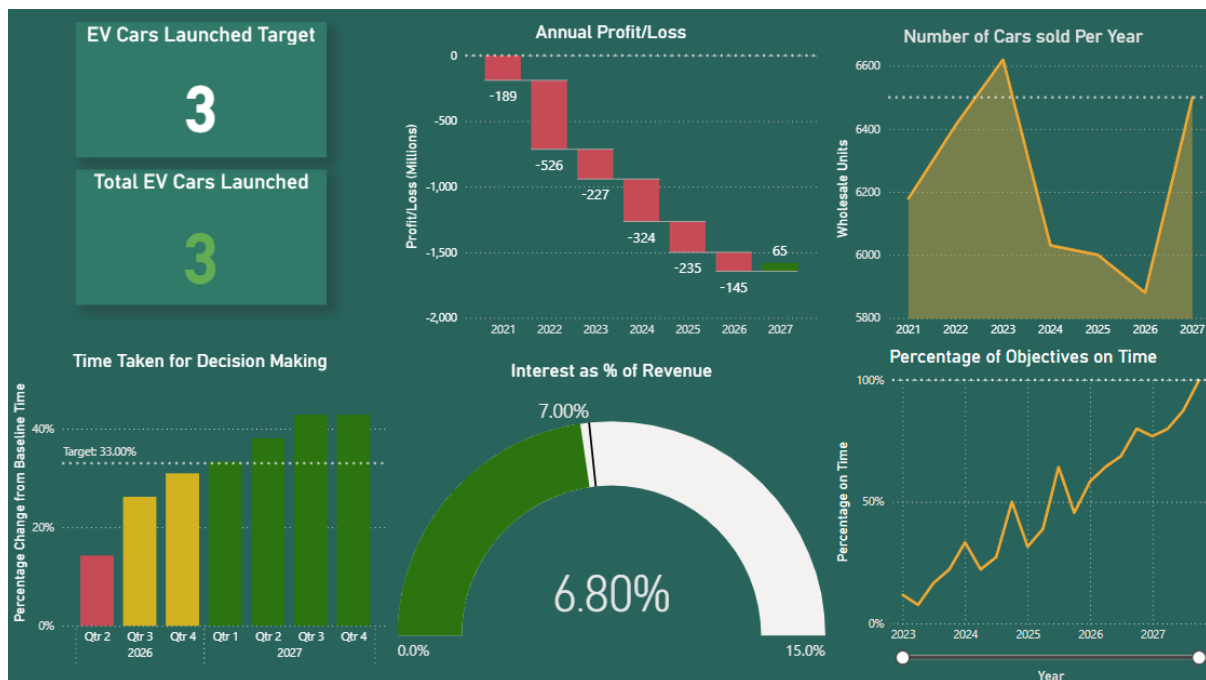
3.2.3 Strategy Mapping



4. Dashboard, Metrics and Justification

4.1. Dashboard Overview

The dashboard employs a 2×3 grid presenting details clearly. The green background represents Aston Martin's British Racing Green. The top row features strategically critical measures, annual profit/loss, EV success, and total sales, enabling stakeholders to assess transition success in seconds. The bottom row displays operational metrics for understanding how actions produce short-term effects.



4.2. KPI Selection

The 6 KPIs were selected based on section 3 analysis, identifying critical systems and variables with significant impact on organisational success.

4.2.1. KPI Choices

4.2.1.1. EV Cars Launched (Top Left)

The target and actual EV launch metric was chosen because it answers a binary question 'Have we met our target? This stems from Root Definition 1 where EV delivery is the ultimate outcome, making it a lagging indicator. This metric shows immediately whether the company has met their EV production goals, with delays reflected as mismatched target and actual values, holding the company accountable to numeric commitments.

4.2.1.2. Net Cash Flow (Top Centre)

Annual profit/loss provides insight into financial performance trajectory. This represents root definition 2's objective of generating a positive cash flow. The balanced scorecard analysis proved that the financial state of Aston critically affects success in other objectives such as the ability to fund EV development. Understanding the financial position and progression is a key factor to unlocking their transformational ability. As a lagging indicator it measures the cumulative result of all operational and strategic decisions made.

4.2.1.3. Wholesale Units Per Year (Top Right)

This customer KPI measures the annual wholesale units. The causal loop shows wholesale units have a large impact on the revenue and EV investment. Unlike the profit/loss metric, this metric provides unambiguous market feedback, as customers either purchase a vehicle or don't. The target of 6,500 units validates that the development of EV vehicles will reverse the decline in sales. This metric acts as both a lagging indicator, showing the sales outcomes of past decisions, and a predictive metric by predicting future revenue generation.

4.2.1.4. Time Taken for Decision Making (Bottom Left)

This learning & growth KPI measures time taken to make strategic and operational decisions, with a baseline established in Q1 2026 and a 33% decrease by Q4 2026. Slow decision-making time was a factor in the delays with EV development and reduced operational efficiency. The balanced scorecard positions decision making as foundational for agility and without it, the transformational governance cannot function effectively. As a leading indicator, faster decision making enables all other improvements to be more effective, and without it even a perfect strategy will be held back.

4.2.1.5. Interest as Percentage of Revenue (Bottom Centre)

This financial KPI measures debt servicing costs as a percentage of the revenue. Stage 5 identified financial constraints as a primary blocking factor for EV development. This metric monitors change 4's debt restructuring success, tracking whether the lower debt servicing reduces revenue percentage consumption, potentially freeing funds for development. As a lagging indicator, it confirms whether completed debt restructuring goals delivered the promised interest relief.

4.2.1.6. Development Objectives Completed on Time (Bottom Right)

This internal KPI measures the percentage of development milestones completed on schedule. Stage 5 identified execution failures causing EV delays due to insufficient assessments. This shows changes 1 and 3 effectiveness, indicating if the transformation governance succeeds and how the partnerships with Lucid and Mercedes-Benz affect the company's development. Unlike vehicles launched, this measure acts as a leading indicator allowing for proactive intervention if milestones slip, providing early warning on the launch targets being achieved.

4.2.1.7. KPI Balance

These six KPIs provide comprehensive monitoring across all four Balanced Scorecard perspectives and three root definition systems. The selection balances leading indicators (milestones, decision cycles) with lagging indicators (cash flow, vehicle launches, interest %, sales volume), enabling both proactive intervention and results validation for executive decision-making.

4.2.2. Visual Choices

EV Cars Launched uses KPI cards displaying target and actual values in large, bold numbers for binary metrics where comparison is instant. Conditional formatting provides pre-attentive status indication through colour (green when on or above target, red when below), responding dynamically to filtering to ensure accuracy.

Annual Profit/Loss uses a waterfall bar chart showing progression from -£189M (2021) to +£65M (2027), with red bars for losses and green for profit. This emphasises sequential building blocks, making the path from loss to profitability visually clear.

Wholesale Units employs an area chart because the filled region emphasises market presence, making the decline to 5,800 units dramatically visible while the recovery creates visual optimism.

Decision-making time uses horizontal bars with colour gradients following natural left-to-right reading patterns. The colour gradient enables instant status recognition without comparing bar lengths, leveraging pre-attentive processing where colour is perceived faster than shape (Ware, 2020). Bar length and quarterly labels ensure the visualisation remains interpretable for colourblind users.

Interest as % of Revenue uses a gauge displaying 6.80% within a 0-15% range. Gauges excel for single value metrics with defined zones while the arc position instantly communicates status. Arc position and the displayed percentage (6.80%) ensure the gauge remains interpretable regardless of colour perception.

Development Objectives On-Time uses a line chart tracking progress from 10% to 100% . The steep upward slope shows improving performance, and any flattening of the line would signal potential problems requiring intervention.

5. Leveraging BI for Enhanced Decision Making

The dashboard enables systematic decision-making through metric-based triggers, replacing Aston Martin's reactive management that contributed to EV delays. When Interest as % of Revenue exceeds 8%, the CFO initiates debt restructuring negotiations, preventing escalation to the unsustainable 12% level. This threshold was selected because debt above 8% blocks transformation investment. Above 10% represents critical territory requiring immediate intervention.

EV Milestones on time percentage triggers escalation at two key thresholds. When milestone achievement falls below 75%, the transformation governance receives automatic alerts within 24 hours, enabling investigation before delays cascade into more serious program issues. This addresses the pattern of delays with Valhalla delivered in December 2025 but only after multiple missed deadlines went undetected. If performance deteriorates below 50%, then the CEO intervenes and reviews the programme internally but also with Mercedes-Benz and Lucid to determine the effectiveness of the partnerships.

Net Cash Flow trends provide early warning of financial deterioration. When losses worsen or mid-year projections exceed previous years, transformation governance initiates capital allocation reviews to reprioritise spending between ICE development, EV programs, and debt repayment. This addresses Stage 5's "poor capital discipline", launching three ICE models despite EV claims. Monitoring trajectories enables early intervention, allowing proactive decisions rather than emergency cuts.

Wholesale unit trends provide market health monitoring. When sales decline year-on-year or mid-year tracking indicates decline, transformation governance initiates brand perception

research and market campaign effectiveness reviews. This addresses stage 5's gap where there is little research occurring. The area chart tracks progress towards the 6,500 unit target, enabling mid-year adjustments.

Decision making cycle time is monitored quarterly towards the 33% reduction target by Q4 2026. After establishing the Q1 2026 baseline, each quarter is assessed against the trajectory. If cycles are not improving sufficiently, transformation governance reviews processes to identify bottlenecks such as approval layers, unclear delegation, or ineffective meeting structures. If cycle times improve ahead of schedule, successful practices are documented. This addresses Stage 5's finding that slow decision-making contributed to EV delays, enabling accelerated responsiveness.

Electrified vehicles launched tracks delivery against targets. When launch numbers fall short the CEO investigates root causes such as partnership issues or funding issues. Launch slippage triggers stakeholder communication to maintain transparency, preventing credibility damage. Meeting targets prompts analysis to identify effective practices for future programs.

If a specific year is selected in the profit/loss graph, the EV launch/target, decision time and interest as % of revenue will all filter for the same year, giving a more in-depth view for comparison purposes.

Business intelligence implementation presents challenges beyond dashboard design. BI integration requires consolidating financial, manufacturing, and partnership data sources. Performance monitoring raises governance concerns, decision-making tracking constitutes employee surveillance requiring GDPR compliance. Organisational BI adoption faces cultural resistance, requiring CEO-level authority. While transitioning from simulated to operational BI requires ongoing investment in data governance, training, and analytics-driven practices.

6. Conclusion

Aston Martin faces an existential challenge: delayed EV entry combined with £323.5M losses and £189.6M debt servicing threatens competitive viability as the EU's 2035 combustion ban eliminates traditional markets. Competitors like Porsche established electric credentials six years earlier while Aston Martin's repeated postponements weakened stakeholder confidence.

This report applied Soft Systems Methodology to analyse the problem, identifying three interdependent failing systems: EV introduction, financial viability, and market positioning. Stage 5 revealed comprehensive failures with financial constraints blocking transformation despite partnerships.

The proposed Business Intelligence dashboard transforms decision-making from reactive management to proactive adaptation. Clear action triggers such as interest >8% initiating debt reviews, milestones <75% prompting investigation and declining cash flow triggering capital reallocation replace subjective negotiations with data-driven protocols. Cross-functional visibility eliminates coordination failures, enabling finance, engineering, and marketing to act on shared data. This prevents repeating past mistakes, building organisational learning capabilities absent when delays went undetected.

Implementation in Q1 2026 alongside transformation governance and debt restructuring positions Aston Martin for phased transformation, with dashboard monitoring providing early warning capabilities.

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